

Keel

A sanctioned academic co-pilot that plans, predicts, advises — and safely acts.
The AI proposes the course; the keel keeps it upright.

Prepared by: _____ · **One backend, two surfaces, four capabilities:** Plan · Register · Advise · Predict · **Safety model:**
intelligence proposes, the engine verifies, models predict, the student approves.

1 The Idea

Keel is a multi-tenant SaaS a university deploys for its students. It runs two React surfaces over one FastAPI backend: an **admin console** where the registrar grounds and configures the agent, and a **chat widget** embedded in the registration portal that students use. A student talks in plain language — “15 credits, Fridays free, must take Data Structures, no 8 AMs” — and Keel produces a valid, conflict-free plan, predicts whether that plan is *wise* (graduation risk and workload, not just legality), explains the trade-offs, and — only after the student approves — executes the enrollment.

It does four things and does them safely. It **plans** (next-semester, full path to graduation, what-if scenarios, and saved/named plans the student can compare and activate), it **registers** (finds open, conflict-free sections matching preferences, waitlists and notifies, and files real institutional requests such as petitions and graduation applications), it **advises** (grounded course information, prerequisite explanations, failure-recovery and major-switch reasoning), and it **predicts** (a trained graduation-risk model and a deterministic workload signal that score every candidate plan). Keel began as a registration copilot; it has matured into a student-success co-pilot — with planning and registration kept as first-class capabilities, not buried under new features.

2 The Problem It Solves

Registration and degree planning are universally painful — hidden time conflicts, prerequisite surprises, full sections, no advisor available at 11 PM, and no clear answer to “am I on track to graduate?” Students fall back on brittle, unsanctioned scraping bots; official advising chatbots only answer questions and route to a human. Keel is the sanctioned middle ground: an assistant that can **safely act** — with tenant isolation, human approval before any write, and a full audit trail — and that doesn’t merely *tell* a student they are at risk, but *builds* them a legal, lower-risk plan, registers it on approval, and files the institutional paperwork that normally requires an office visit.

3 Core Design Principle — Propose · Verify · Predict · Explain

The defining rule: **the LLM never decides feasibility, and never predicts outcomes**. Three kinds of work live in three layers. Hard constraints (prerequisites, time conflicts, capacity, credit caps, offering term, holds) are owned by a **deterministic engine** and are non-negotiable. Outcome estimates (graduation risk, workload) are owned by **prediction models**. Everything fuzzy, conflicting, and underspecified — what the student actually wants, which plan to propose, how to rank and explain it — is where the **LLM** genuinely decides.

The LLM decides (soft · fuzzy · generative)

Intent classification (when ambiguous) · constraint & preference extraction from natural language · proposing candidate plans, elective sets, orderings · ranking and explaining trade-offs · repairing a plan from structured violations · drafting petitions and request justifications · advisory recommendations.

The engine guarantees (hard · exact · verified)

Prerequisite ordering (DAG topological check) · time-conflict detection · section capacity · credit caps · offering-term cadence · corequisites · registration holds · eligibility · workload aggregation (difficulty index) · idempotent, transactional enrollment write.

The models predict (probabilistic · learned)

Graduation-risk classifier (trained, compared ML vs DL vs LLM, with class-imbalance handling) scores a *valid* plan as on-track / at-risk and feeds a mitigation explanation. **GPA estimate** is an explicit LLM baseline — the weak, uncalibrated option, framed as such. **Workload** is deterministic, not a model.

How the three layers meet

A **generate–verify–repair loop**: the LLM proposes, the engine validates and returns structured violations, the LLM repairs and re-proposes; valid candidates are then *scored* by the models, and the LLM ranks and explains using both feasibility and risk. A greedy deterministic planner sits behind it as a fallback.

Intelligence **proposes**. Deterministic systems **verify**. Models **predict**. Execution requires **approval**.

4 What Keel Does — Features

Every feature reuses a small set of engines (the deterministic core, the advising RAG, the LLM, the model-server) and a single **action pattern** — propose → engine-validate → human-approve → idempotent transactional write → audit. The modules below are *intents and actions over those engines*, not independent pipelines. Each card states why it exists, its constraints, how AI is used, and what stays deterministic.

MODULE A — PLANNING

A1 Next-Semester Planning

MVP

PURPOSE	Answer “what should I take next term?” and feed registration. Core of the demo.
CONSTRAINTS	Plan must satisfy prerequisites, credit caps, corequisites, no repeats of passed courses, degree progress.
AI	LLM extracts hard constraints + soft preferences, proposes 2–3 candidate plans (balanced / graduation-focused / lighter), ranks and explains.
DETERMINISTIC	Audit engine builds the eligible course pool; verifier validates every candidate and returns structured violations.

A2 Graduation Planning

MVP

PURPOSE	Map the whole path from current term to graduation — the “am I on track, and how?” answer.
CONSTRAINTS	Full multi-term path must respect the prerequisite DAG, offering cadence, and per-term credit limits end-to-end.
AI	LLM optimizes the skeleton toward a goal (fastest / balanced / easier terms) and explains the sequence.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine computes remaining requirements and credits, generates the path skeleton, validates the whole path.

A3 What-If Simulation

MVP

PURPOSE	“What if I switch to Math?” / “Can I graduate a semester early?” — re-audit under modified assumptions.
CONSTRAINTS	Returns graduation date + required credits-per-term; never presents an infeasible alternative as feasible.
AI	LLM explains consequences and trade-offs of the change.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine recomputes audit against the target program and derives the new timeline.

A4 Saved Plans — Save / Load / Activate

MVP

PURPOSE	Persist named plans (“Fast Graduation”, “Easy Semester”, “Career-aligned”); load, compare, and activate one. Foundational — swap, replanning, and invalidation all build on it.
CONSTRAINTS	A first-class, versioned Plan entity with exactly one active plan; every saved plan was verifier-valid at save time and is re-validated on load if the catalog changed.
AI	None for storage; the LLM names and explains plans on request.
DETERMINISTIC	Plan entity, versioning, activation, and the comparison view.

A5 Course Swap

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	“Replace Database with Networks” → validate → update the active plan.
CONSTRAINTS	The swap must keep the plan verifier-valid (prerequisites, conflicts, credits); reject and explain if it cannot.
AI	LLM interprets the request and explains the consequence of the swap.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine re-validates the edited plan; idempotent transactional update on the Plan entity.

A6 Automatic Replanning

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	A saved plan becomes invalid (course removed, prerequisite changed, section cancelled) → re-audit, re-plan, notify the student. A strong engineering feature.
CONSTRAINTS	Scope which saved plans are actually affected; recompute must converge or flag for a human; avoid notification storms.
AI	LLM explains what changed and what the recompute did.
DETERMINISTIC	Background worker re-runs audit + planner on affected plans; transactional write + outbox notification.

MODULE B — REGISTRATION

B1 Registration Assistant

MVP

PURPOSE	Turn an approved plan (or manually named courses) into a real, conflict-free enrollment.
CONSTRAINTS	A phased, bounded workflow — not an open agent loop. Engine owns eligibility; the write requires explicit approval and is transactional + idempotent.
AI	LLM interprets schedule preferences and explains the section options. Limited, deliberately.
DETERMINISTIC	Section search returns open, conflict-free combinations; idempotent enrollment write executes on approval.

B2 Waitlist (Join / Leave) & Seat Tracking

MVP

PURPOSE	Full section? Join or leave a waitlist as first-class actions; “notify me when a seat opens.”
CONSTRAINTS	Email-on-seat-open retries with backoff and never breaks the user-facing response.
AI	None — pure workflow.
DETERMINISTIC	Background RQ worker polls capacity; transactional waitlist writes; notification via the outbox.

MODULE C — ADVISING

C1 Course Advisor (RAG)

MVP

PURPOSE	Answer what a course covers, what it unlocks, and what it requires — grounded, never invented.
CONSTRAINTS	Prerequisite chains are grounded in the DAG, so the model cannot invent a prerequisite.
AI	Hybrid retrieval + rerank over the tenant’s catalog and policy documents; LLM answers from context with sources.
DETERMINISTIC	Retrieval is tenant-filtered; prerequisite facts come from the DAG, not the prose.

C2 Degree Audit Chat

MVP

PURPOSE	“What do I still need to graduate?” in plain language.
CONSTRAINTS	Numbers come from the engine; the LLM may not restate them incorrectly.
AI	LLM summarizes the audit result conversationally.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine computes missing requirements, remaining credits, and required courses.

C3 Academic Advisor Chat — Failure Recovery

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	“I failed Data Structures. Am I doomed?” — turn a setback into a concrete recovery plan.
CONSTRAINTS	Recovery plan must itself pass the verifier; graduation-impact figures come from the engine.
AI	LLM composes the recovery narrative and re-plan rationale. Genuine reasoning + explanation.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine computes downstream delayed courses and the graduation-date impact.

C4 Major-Switch Advisor

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	“Should I switch majors?” — adds a recommendation layer on top of A3’s what-if. (The <i>action</i> to file the switch lives in F2.)
CONSTRAINTS	Consequences (lost credits, new timeline) are engine-computed; recommendation is advisory, not a guarantee.
AI	LLM analyzes performance patterns and strengths and frames a recommendation.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine computes graduation consequences against each candidate program.

MODULE D — PREDICTION (the layer instructors asked to see)

D1 Graduation-Risk Predictor

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	“Am I on track?” — the headline ML feature. Scores a valid plan on-track / at-risk and drives a mitigation plan.
CONSTRAINTS	A trained model (one of the two trained models), compared three ways — classical ML vs a small DL model (ONNX) vs an LLM baseline — macro-F1 gates CI, with class-imbalance handling and per-class recall reported (at-risk is the minority class you care about). Served lean (no torch in containers).
AI	ML model produces the risk score + reasons; the LLM generates the mitigation plan from those reasons.
DETERMINISTIC	Inputs (GPA trajectory, failed courses, progress rate, current load) are computed by the engine.

D2 Workload Signal

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	“How heavy is this semester?” — the second half of “is this plan <i>wise</i> ?”
CONSTRAINTS	Deterministic by design — a difficulty-weighted aggregation (per-course difficulty × credits → light / medium / heavy). Not a third trained model, to keep training scope at two.
AI	None for the score; the LLM only narrates it inside plan explanations.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine aggregates the difficulty index. (May become a trained model later — see Data Sources, TBA.)

D3 GPA Estimate

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	“What GPA might I get with this plan?” — a light, advisory estimate.
CONSTRAINTS	Implemented as an LLM baseline and labelled as the weak, uncalibrated option — a live example of the “when <i>not</i> to use an LLM” lesson. Not a headline; never a guarantee.
AI	LLM estimate from transcript + course difficulty + load. Swappable for a model later.
DETERMINISTIC	Feature inputs are engine-computed; the estimate is explicitly bounded and caveated.

MODULE E — GUIDANCE

E1 Personalized Elective Recommender

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	Rank electives by fit (strengths, GPA goals, difficulty preference, career direction).
CONSTRAINTS	Only recommends electives that exist in the catalog and are eligible — grounded in the DAG + audit, so it cannot suggest a course the student can't take.
AI	LLM ranks and justifies using the transcript strengths/weaknesses analysis.
DETERMINISTIC	Eligible elective set comes from the engine; strengths/weaknesses from transcript analysis.

E2 Career Path Recommender

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	"I want to become an AI Engineer" → map interests + strengths to a direction and the catalog electives/skills that align. The resulting roadmap can be saved as a career-aligned plan via A4 STRETCH .
CONSTRAINTS	The one feature with no hard verifier and no ground truth — framed explicitly as a <i>suggestion</i> , not a prediction. Recommendations are grounded in the real catalog so it cannot invent courses; it feeds E1 and the planning goal.
AI	LLM maps career interest → relevant skills → recommended catalog electives → projects.
DETERMINISTIC	Course/skill grounding is catalog-bound via RAG + DAG.

MODULE F — INSTITUTIONAL REQUESTS (routed to the registrar in the admin console — no extra role)

F1 Graduation Application

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	"Am I ready to graduate?" → audit confirms eligibility → apply for graduation. The natural terminal action of the planning arc.
CONSTRAINTS	The engine confirms all requirements are met before the action is offered; the write is idempotent and audit-logged, routed to the registrar.
AI	LLM explains readiness; it does not decide eligibility.
DETERMINISTIC	Audit eligibility check; application write to the institutional-request queue.

F2 Major-Change Request

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	"Switch to Data Science" → impact analysis (C4) → submit a major-change request to the registrar.
CONSTRAINTS	Consequences are engine-computed; the request is a routed write, not an auto-approved change.
AI	LLM frames the impact summary attached to the request.
DETERMINISTIC	Engine computes lost credits / new timeline; request write + audit.

F3 Petition / Prerequisite Override

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	Student wants a course they don't satisfy prerequisites for → engine explains the block → LLM drafts a justified petition → submit an exception request.
CONSTRAINTS	The engine still refuses to auto-enroll ; the petition is a request to a <i>human</i> , not a bypass — the seatbelt gains a sanctioned override path, it is not removed.
AI	LLM drafts the petition from the student's stated justification + transcript context.
DETERMINISTIC	Eligibility-block detection; petition write routed to the registrar; audit.

F4 Advisor Escalation — Email + Handoff Summary

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	"I want to talk to an advisor" / an out-of-scope turn → decide escalation → generate a handoff summary → email it to the advisor.
CONSTRAINTS	No advisor role, login, or dashboard. Escalation is an email carrying the summary; an optional appointment request is a recorded row, not a calendar integration.
AI	LLM decides escalation and writes the handoff summary — conversation recap, transcript summary, failed constraints, recommended actions.
DETERMINISTIC	Escalation routing; email via the outbox; audit.

MODULE G — PROACTIVE & MULTILINGUAL

G1 Personalized Alerts

ADVANCED

PURPOSE	Proactive notifications: a seat opened, you can now take X (eligibility unlocked), graduation risk crossed a threshold, the registration window is opening.
CONSTRAINTS	A fixed small set of triggers (~4) , not a general rules engine; deduplicated; delivered in-app and by email.
AI	LLM phrases the alert; the triggers themselves are deterministic.
DETERMINISTIC	Background worker evaluates trigger rules; notification table; outbox delivery.

G2 Multilingual Support

STRETCH

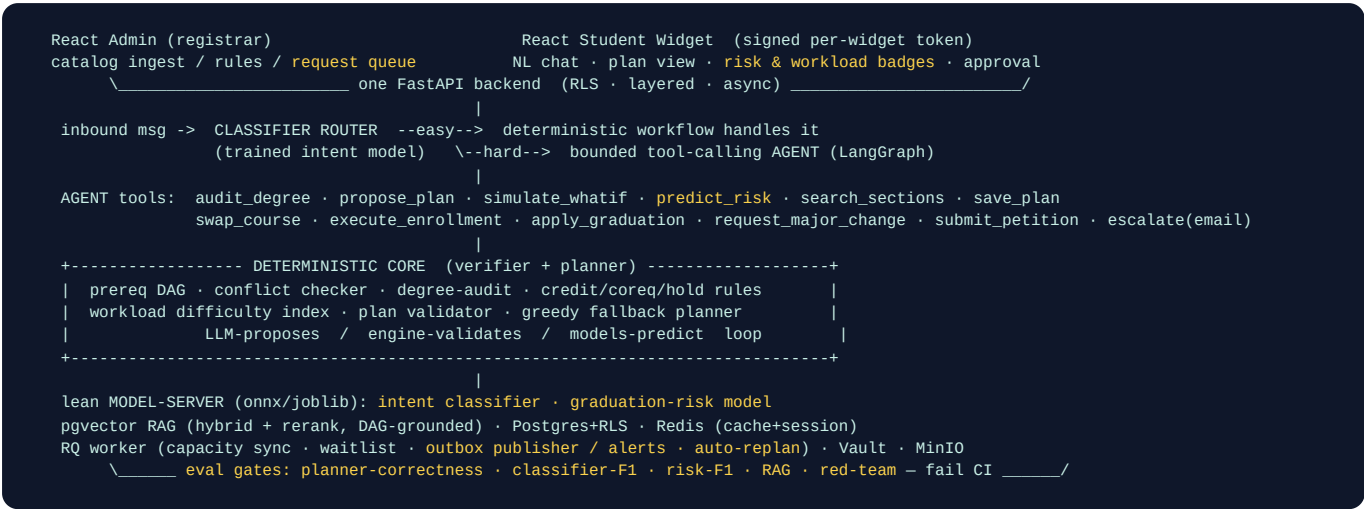
PURPOSE	Arabic / French / English — locally relevant for the deploying institution.
CONSTRAINTS	Low architectural complexity — prompt + UI; engine and predictions are language-agnostic.
AI	LLM responds in the student's language; retrieval stays grounded.
DETERMINISTIC	No change to the engine, verifier, or writes.

5 Roles & Access

Role	Powers
Admin (registrar)	Grounds the agent — uploads catalog & policy docs; sets registration rules (credit caps, holds, windows); configures persona, enabled tools, guardrails; manages the widget embed snippet and allowed origins; reviews audit log and per-tenant cost; and works the institutional-request queue (graduation applications, major-change requests, petitions).
Student	Uses the chat widget — asks in plain language, reviews the proposed conflict-free plan, its predicted risk/workload, and trade-offs, saves and compares plans, and approves before any enrollment or request executes. Scoped to their own identity and transcript.
Platform operator	Provisions, suspends, and erases university tenants. Never reads a tenant's conversations or data — a controlled doorway, not god mode. Every action is audit-logged.

Three named roles, fixed powers — deliberately no configurable RBAC matrix and no separate advisor role. Advisor escalation is an **email with a handoff summary**, not a login; institutional requests are worked by the registrar in the existing admin console.

6 Architecture Overview

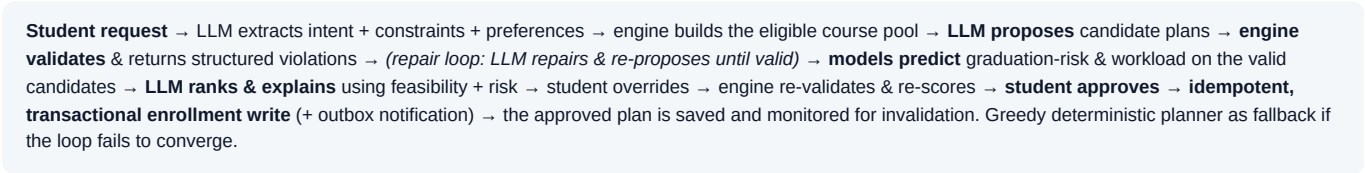


Key subsystems

- Plan entity** — a first-class, versioned, named plan with one active version. Underpins save/load/activate (A4), course swap (A5), and automatic replanning (A6).
- Institutional-request queue** — one inbox the registrar works for graduation applications, major-change requests, and petitions (F1–F3). One subsystem, not four features, and no new role.
- Action pattern + outbox** — every side-effecting write (enrollment, waitlist, requests, alerts) follows propose → validate → approve → **transactional write + outbox event** → audit. The outbox avoids dual-write inconsistency between the write and its notification/email.

7 The Planning Loop (refined)

The linear pipeline becomes a **generate–verify–predict–explain loop**, with prediction inserted only after feasibility is proven (no point scoring an illegal plan):



8 Core AI Components

- Intent classifier** (register / plan / advise / predict) — a real **trained** model compared three ways (classical ML, a small DL model exported to ONNX, an LLM zero-shot baseline); macro-F1 gates CI. Kept trained on purpose: the router exists to keep the LLM off cheap, enumerable decisions.

- **Graduation-risk model** — the second **trained** model; same three-way comparison; class-imbalance handling; risk-F1 (and at-risk recall) gates CI; feeds the LLM mitigation plan.
- **Constraint & preference extraction** — structured Pydantic outputs turn free text into typed hard constraints and soft preferences.
- **Plan proposal & repair** — the LLM proposes candidates inside the generate-and-verify loop and repairs them from the engine's structured violations.
- **Advising RAG** — hybrid retrieval + rerank over catalog & policy, with faithful, **DAG-grounded** prerequisite explanations.
- **Drafting & explanation** — petition drafts, handoff summaries, trade-off explanations, strengths/weaknesses, mitigation, and recommendations.
- **Guardrails** — prompt-injection / cross-tenant refusal and PII redaction before anything leaves the service boundary.

9 Core Software-Engineering Components

- **Multi-tenant isolation** — Postgres Row-Level Security + repository-layer scoping + tenant-filtered pgvector. *Isolation is the grade.*
- **Layered backend** (api / services / repositories / domain / infra), async throughout, dependency injection, lifespan singletons, typed boundaries.
- **First-class Plan entity** (versioned, named, active) and the **institutional-request queue** worked by the registrar — no extra role.
- **Transactional writes + outbox pattern** for the write-and-notify path (enrollment, waitlist, requests, alerts) to avoid dual-write inconsistency; idempotency keys; an audit-log row on every write.
- **Background jobs** — an RQ / Redis worker for capacity sync, waitlist processing, email-on-seat-open, personalized alerts, and automatic replanning (retry + backoff, structured logging).
- **Caching** with deliberate invalidation on catalog change; per-tenant rate limiting.
- **Widget auth** — signed, short-lived per-widget token + server-side origin check (CORS / CSP as defense-in-depth, never the boundary).
- **Secrets in Vault**, blob in MinIO, OpenTelemetry / LangSmith tracing, Alembic migrations, `docker-compose up` from a clean clone, GitHub Actions CI with eval gates.

10 MVP · Advanced · Stretch

Tier	Scope
MVP the demo spine	Intent classifier + router · constraint extraction · next-semester / graduation / what-if planning (propose → verify → repair loop) · first-class Plan entity with save/load/activate · registration (section search + idempotent transactional execute + approval) · waitlist join/leave + seat-tracking + email worker · Course Advisor RAG (hybrid + rerank) · Degree Audit chat · multi-tenant RLS · widget signed-token auth · Vault · layered backend · outbox writes · CI eval gates (planner-correctness + classifier-F1 + RAG + red-team).
ADVANCED	Graduation-risk model + LLM mitigation · failure-recovery chat · major-switch advisor · personalized elective recommender · GPA estimate (LLM) · workload signal (deterministic) · course swap · automatic replanning · institutional requests (graduation application, major-change request, petition/override) · advisor escalation email + handoff summary · personalized alerts (capped triggers) · career-path recommender (catalog-grounded).
STRETCH	Multilingual support (Arabic / French / English) · career roadmap saved as a plan · NeMo Guardrails sidecar (vs. lightweight in-process rails for MVP).

11 Evaluation & Quality Gates (fail CI on regression)

- **Planner correctness** — the headline gate. No generated plan ever violates a prerequisite, time conflict, capacity, credit cap, or hold; the verifier proves it on a golden set.
- **Intent classifier** — macro-F1 on the held-out test set, with the ML / DL / LLM three-way comparison committed alongside.
- **Graduation-risk model** — macro-F1 *and per-class recall on the at-risk minority* on a held-out split; three-way comparison committed; the model card discloses the data source (see §12).
- **Agent tool-selection** — given a message, did it pick the right tool (or correctly pick none)?
- **RAG** — retrieval (hit@k, MRR) and generation (faithfulness, relevancy) on a hand-curated golden set.
- **Red-team / write-action safety** — cross-tenant and prompt-injection probes must all be refused; a fake key never leaks unredacted; and **no injected or unapproved request ever produces a write** (enrollment, petition, major-change, graduation application). Testing the action pattern once covers every action.

12 Data Sources & Honesty TBA

- **Catalog & policy documents** — tenant-provided; a mock catalog with a real prerequisite DAG is seeded for the demo.
- **Intent dataset** — a small labeled text-classification set (public or hand-curated), held out with no leakage.
- **Graduation-risk data** — TBA. Preferred path: a suitable public student-performance / at-risk dataset, if one fits the feature schema. Fallback: **synthetic data, generated honestly**, with explicit class-imbalance handling (the at-risk class is the minority).

On synthetic data — the framing that survives a defense. Real transcript data is privacy-protected (FERPA), which is the legitimate reason to synthesize. The data is generated with a **deliberate, documented signal plus injected noise** — never “purely random” (random data is unlearnable, which would make the model useless). The model card states plainly that the model learns *the generator’s notion of risk, not validated real-world risk*; a small slice is hand-labeled and reported; macro-F1 and at-risk recall are gated on a held-out split. This is the Week-3 “weak supervision, documented honestly” lesson applied directly.

13 Tech Stack (every choice justified; nothing decorative)

Technology	Why it earns its place
React (admin + widget)	Two distinct surfaces; the widget is the production-shaped, embeddable student UI.
FastAPI + Pydantic	Async API, typed boundaries, structured LLM/tool I/O.
LangGraph bounded agent	Tool-calling agent for the <i>hard</i> turns only; bounded loop = cost + safety control.
Deterministic engine	The core of the project — DAG, conflict checker, audit, validator, greedy fallback. The differentiator lives here.
Postgres + RLS + Alembic	One DB for everything; RLS enforces tenant isolation at the database. Hosts the Plan entity, request queue, outbox, and audit log.
pgvector (hybrid + rerank)	Advising RAG in the same database, tenant-filtered by construction.
Model-server (ONNX / joblib)	Intent + graduation-risk served lean — no torch in any container ; train offline, serve light.

Technology	Why it earns its place
Redis + RQ worker	Session memory + cache; background capacity sync, waitlist, alerts, outbox publishing, auto-replan.
Signed per-widget token	Real widget auth; CORS/CSP are defense-in-depth, never the boundary.
Vault · MinIO	Secrets at startup; blob for model artifacts, eval reports, snapshots.
Email (Resend / SMTP)	Seat-open notifications, alerts, and advisor-escalation emails — all via the outbox.
Docker Compose · GitHub Actions	One-command stack from a clean clone; CI with eval gates that fail on regression.
OpenTelemetry / LangSmith	Traces over every LLM/tool/retrieval call; joinable with redacted logs.
NeMo Guardrails (sidecar)	Topical + injection rails as a sidecar; a lightweight in-process layer covers the MVP.
STRETCH	

Deliberately not adopted (and why) — MLflow registry / drift / retraining pipeline: overkill for two small static models on synthetic data; model cards + SHA-256 + refuse-to-boot + CI eval gates already provide controlled promotion at the right scale. MCP / A2A multi-agent: would contradict the deliberate single-bounded-agent design — one agent behind a trained router is the correct, cheaper choice. GraphRAG: the prerequisite DAG is already used *deterministically* by the engine, which is stricter and more accurate than approximating it with graph retrieval. Benchmarks/leaderboards, enterprise connectors, fine-tuned large transformer: no real fit — each would cost build time without serving the project.

14 Deliverables

A public GitHub repository that comes up with a single `docker-compose up` from a clean clone: React admin + student widget, FastAPI backend, the deterministic engine, the lean model-server, a mock registration database and portal, seeded tenants, CI with eval gates, and the documentation set — `SPEC.md` (component specs written before the code), `DESIGN.md`, `DECISIONS.md`, `PLANNER.md` (the engine + verifier + outbox contract), `DATA.md` (the synthetic-data honesty note), `EVALS.md`, `RUNBOOK.md`, `SECURITY.md` — plus a short demo video of one end-to-end run from the widget through to a safely executed enrollment and a filed institutional request.

15 Scope Notes & Risks

- **The deterministic engine is the real time sink — and the core value.** The DAG, conflict checker, audit, and the generate-verify-repair loop are the hardest, least AI-assistant-friendly parts and they exist before any expansion. Build the engine correct first; a leaky verifier undermines everything above it.
- **Two trained models, no more.** Intent + graduation-risk. GPA is a light LLM baseline; workload is deterministic. Resisting a third training job is a deliberate choice, not a gap.
- **Action sprawl lives in the test surface, not the code.** Every approval-gated write is something an injection could try to trigger. The single action pattern (validate → approve → transactional write + outbox + audit) is tested once and reused, so adding actions stays cheap and safe.
- **Career path is the soft spot.** No verifier, no ground truth — framed as a grounded *suggestion*, with a prepared “I don’t claim correctness here” answer.
- **Richness without sprawl.** The features are intents and actions over a few engines plus two new subsystems (Plan entity, request queue), not independent pipelines. Depth on the planning loop, the predict layer, and the safe-write path beats breadth across half-built features.